

GLOXINIA

GLOXINIA

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of rhizomatous perennials or shrubs. Frost tender. Needs partial shade and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Dies down in late fall or winter; then keep rhizomes nearly dry. Propagate by division or seed in spring, or by stem or leaf cuttings in summer.

G. perennis. Late summer- to fall-flowering rhizome. H to 2ft (60cm), S 12–14in (30–35cm). Has heart-shaped, toothed, hairy leaves on spotted stems and bell-shaped, lavender-blue flowers, with rounded lobes and purple-blotched throats. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)
G. speciosa. See *Sinningia speciosa*.
G. tubiflora. See *Sinningia tubiflora*.

GLYCERIA

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.

G. aquatica ‘Variegata’. See *G. maxima* var. *variegata*.
G. maxima ‘Variegata’. See *G. maxima* var. *variegata*.
G. maxima var. *variegata*, syn. *G. aquatica* ‘Variegata’, *G. maxima* ‘Variegata’, illus. p.436.

GLYCYRRHIZA

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of summer-flowering perennials grown for their spikes of pealike blooms. The roots of *G. glabra* are the source of liquorice. Needs sun and deep, rich, well-drained soil. Suitable for a wild garden or informal border. Propagate by division in spring, or by seed in fall or spring.
G. glabra, syn. *G. glandulifera* (Liquorice, Sweetwood). Upright, tap-rooted perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 3ft (1m). Large, sticky leaves are divided into ovate leaflets. Short spikes of pealike, purple-blue and white flowers are borne on erect stems in late summer. Z9–11
G. glandulifera. See *G. glabra*.

Godetia. See *Clarkia*.

GOEPPERTIA

SYN. CALATHEA

MARANTACEAE

Genus of evergreen, rhizomatous, clump-forming perennials, previously included in the genus *Calathea*, grown for their attractive, brightly colored and patterned foliage. Frost tender. Requires partial shade and a humid position, without fluctuations of temperature, in moist, well-drained, humus-rich soil. Propagate by division in spring.
G. lindeniana, syn. *Calathea linendiana*. Evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Lance-shaped, long-stalked, more or less upright leaves, over 1ft (30cm) long, are dark green, with paler green, feathered midribs above and marked with reddish-purple below. Intermittently produces short, erect spikes of 3-petaled, pale yellow flowers. Z14–15 (min. 61–70°F/16–21°C)

G. majestica ‘Roseolineata’, syn. *Calathea majestica* ‘Roseolineata’, *Calathea ornata* ‘Roseolineata’. Evergreen, clump-forming, stemless perennial. H to 6ft (2m), S to 5ft (1.5m). Narrowly ovate, leathery leaves, to 2ft (60cm) long, are dark green, finely veined pink, and reddish-purple below. Intermittently bears short, erect spikes of 3-petaled, white to mauve flowers. Z14–15. (min. 61–70°F/16–21°C).
‘Sanderiana’ (syn. *Calathea ornata* ‘Sanderiana’, *G. sanderiana*) illus. p.472.
G. makoyana, syn. *Calathea makoyana*, (Peacock plant), illus. p.475.
G. sanderiana. See *G. majestica* ‘Sanderiana’.
G. zebrina, syn. *Calathea zebrina* (Zebra plant), illus. p.475.

GOMESA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.

G. flexuosa, syn. *Oncidium flexuosum* (Dancing-doll orchid; illus. p.467). Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool or intermediate greenhouse. H 9in (23cm). In fall produces terminal sprays of many small, large-lipped, bright yellow flowers, ¼in (0.5cm) across, with red-brown markings on the sepals and petals. Bears narrowly ovate leaves, 4in (10cm) long. Best grown on a bark slab. Keep in semi-shade in summer. Z13–15 (min. 55°F/13°C)
G. planifolia. Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool greenhouse. H 9in (23cm). Sprays of star-shaped, pea-green flowers, ¼in (0.5cm) across, are produced in fall. Narrowly ovate leaves are 6in (15cm) long. Grow in semishade during summer. Z14–15 (min. 55°F/13°C)

GOMPHOCARPUS

APOCYNACEAE/ASCLEPIADACEAE

Genus of evergreen and deciduous subshrubs and perennials. Hooded, cup-shaped flowers are followed by seed pods that are usually inflated. Grows in sun or partial shade and in any well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or softwood cuttings in spring. ☉Some species exude a milky sap, which may aggravate skin allergies.
G. physocarpus, syn. *Asclepias physocarpa* (Swan plant). Deciduous, erect, hairy subshrub. H to 6ft (2m), S to 2ft (60cm). Has lance-shaped leaves, 4in (10cm) long, and umbels of 5-horned, creamy-white flowers in summer, followed by large, inflated, globular seed pods with soft bristles. Z12–15

GOMPHRENA

AMARANTHACEAE

Genus of annuals, occasionally perennials. Only one species, *G. globosa*, is usually cultivated; its flower heads are good for cutting and drying. Grows best in sun and in fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed sown under glass in spring.
G. globosa (Globe amaranth) illus. p.303.

Gordonia axillaris. See *Polyspora axillaris*.

GRAPTOPETALUM

CRASSULACEAE

Genus of rosetted, perennial succulents very similar to *Echeveria*, with which it hybridizes. Frost tender. Easy to grow, needing sun or partial shade and very well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or by stem or leaf cuttings in spring or summer.
G. amethystinum. Clump-forming, prostrate, perennial succulent. H 16in (40cm), S 3ft (90cm). Thick, rounded, blue-gray to red leaves are 3in (7cm) long, in terminal rosettes. In spring–summer, bears star-shaped, yellow-and-red flowers, ½–¾in (1–2cm) across. Z13–15 (min. 50°F/10°C)
G. bellum, syn. *Tacitus bellus*, illus. p.485.
G. paraguayense (Mother-of-pearl plant) illus. p.489.

GRAPTOPHYLLUM

ACANTHACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, grown mainly for their foliage. Frost tender. Needs partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Water potted plants freely when in full growth, less when temperatures are low. Young plants need tip pruning after flowering to promote branching; leggy specimens may be cut back hard after flowering or in spring. Propagate by greenwood or semiripe cuttings in spring or summer.
G. pictum (Caricature plant). Evergreen, erect, loose shrub. H to 6ft (2m), S 2ft (60cm) or more. Has ovate, pointed, glossy, green leaves with central, yellow blotches. Bears short, terminal spikes of tubular, red to purple flowers in spring and early summer. Z13–15 (min. 55°F/13°C)

GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, AND SEDGES

Group of evergreen or herbaceous, perennial and annual grasses or grass-like plants belonging to the Gramineae (including Bambusoideae), Juncaceae and Cyperaceae families. They are grown mainly as foliage plants, adding grace and contrast to borders and rock gardens, although several grasses have attractive flower heads in summer that may be dried for winter decoration. Dead foliage may be cut back on herbaceous perennials when dormant. Propagate species by seed in spring or fall or by division in spring; selected forms by division only. Pests and diseases usually give little trouble. Grasses, bamboos, rushes and sedges are illustrated on pp.284–289.

Grasses (Gramineae)

Family of evergreen, semievergreen or herbaceous, sometimes creeping perennials, annuals and marginal water plants, usually with rhizomes or stolons, that form tufts, clumps or carpets. All have basal leaves and rounded flower stems that bear alternate, long, narrow leaves. Flowers are bisexual (males and females in same spikelet) and are arranged in panicles, racemes or spikes. Each flower head comprises spikelets, with one or more florets, that are covered with glumes (scales) from which awns (long, slender bristles) may grow. Unless otherwise

stated, grasses will tolerate a range of light conditions and flourish in any well-drained soil. Many genera, such as *Briza*, self-seed readily.

See also *Alopecurus*, *Anemanthele*, *Arrhenatherum*, *Arundo*, *Bouteloua*, *Briza*, *Chionochloa*, *Coix*, *Cortaderia*, *Deschampsia*, *Festuca*, *Glyceria*, *Hakonechloa*, *Helictotrichon*, *Hordeum*, *Lagurus*, *Lamarckia*, *Leymus*, *Melica*, *Melinis*, *Milium*, *Miscanthus*, *Molinia*, *Oplismenus*, *Panicum*, *Pennisetum*, *Phalaris*, *Sesleria*, *Setaria*, *Spartina*, *Stenotaphrum*, *Stipa*, *Zea* and *Zizania*.

Bamboos (Bambusoideae)

Sub-family of Gramineae, comprising evergreen, rhizomatous perennials, sometimes grown as hedging as well as for ornamentation. Most bamboos differ from other perennial grasses in that they have woody stems (culms). These are hollow (except in *Chusquea*), mostly greenish-brown and, due to their silica content, very strong, with a circumference of up to 6in (15cm) in some tropical species. Leaves are lance-shaped with cross veins that give a tessellated appearance, which may be obscured in the more tender species. Flowers are produced at varying intervals but are not decorative. After flowering, stems die down, but few plants die completely. Bamboos thrive in a sheltered, not too dry site in sun or shade, unless otherwise stated.

See also *Bambusa*, *Chusquea*, *Fargesia*, *Himalayacalamus*, *Phyllostachys*, *Pleioblastus*, *Pseudosasa*, *Sasa*, *Semiarundinaria*, *Shibataea* and *Yushania*.

Rushes (Juncaceae)

Family of evergreen, tuft-forming or creeping, mostly rhizomatous annuals and perennials. All have either rounded, leafless stems or stems bearing long, narrow, basal leaves that are flat and hairless except *Luzula* (woodrushes) which has flat leaves, edged with white hairs. Rounded flower heads are generally unimportant. Most rushes prefer sun or partial shade and a moist or wet situation, but *Luzula* prefers drier conditions. See also *Isolepis*, *Juncus* and *Luzula*.

Sedges (Cyperaceae)

Family of evergreen, rhizomatous perennials that form dense tufts. Stems are triangular and bear long, narrow leaves, sometimes reduced to scales. Spikes or panicles of florets covered with glumes are produced and contain both male and female flowers, although some species of *Carex* have separate male and female flower heads on the same stem. Grow in sun or partial shade. Some sedges grow naturally in water, but many may be grown in any well-drained soil.

See also *Carex*, *Cyperus*, *Eleocharis*, *Schoenoplectus* and *Scirpoides*.

GREVILLEA

PROTEACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, grown for their flowers and foliage. Grow in full sun and well-drained, preferably acidic soil. Water potted specimens moderately, very little in winter. Pruning